T3000

Glossary · built Nov 13, 2026

Glossary

The words this manual uses in a particular way. Where a term also has an everyday meaning, the entry gives the meaning T3000 gives it.

The system

Term	Meaning
Panel	A controller on the network. Used interchangeably with *controller* and *device*; a panel holds the points, the programs and the database record.
T3	The Temco Controls controller family. A T3 is the panel most of this manual describes.
TStat8	The Temco Controls thermostat. It has its own points and schedules and is documented separately.
Expansion module	A board that adds points to a panel — `T3-8O` for outputs, `T3-22I` for inputs, `T3-PT12` for temperature. It carries its own serial number and names its parent.
Subnet	The group of panels reachable on one network segment. Panels are found and read by scanning their subnet.
Serial number	The identity of a panel. Everything T3000 keeps about a panel is keyed by it, and it does not change when the panel's address does.
Modbus ID	The address a panel answers to on a serial Modbus segment. Two panels on one segment cannot share one.
BACnet instance	The object number a device answers to on a BACnet network, in the same role the Modbus ID plays on Modbus.
Scan	Asking the network what is there. A scan can run automatically when T3000 opens or on demand.
PTP	The connection T3000 uses to reach a panel through the Temco server when neither end can be dialled directly.

Points

Term	Meaning
Point	One addressable value on a panel — an input, an output or a variable.
Input	A value read from the panel's terminals: a temperature, a contact, a pulse count.
Output	A value the panel drives: a relay, a 0–10 V signal, a triac.
Variable	A value the panel holds for its own use — a setpoint, a counter, a flag.
Analog / digital	Whether a point carries a number or is on or off.
Range	The engineering meaning of an input's raw value: what a reading of 4 mA or 500 counts represents.
Custom digital range	A digital range with a label of its own, so a contact reads as *Filter dirty* rather than *Off*.
Pulse counting	Counting digital transitions over time instead of reporting a state.
Point type	Which of the three tables a point lives in: `INPUT`, `OUTPUT` or `VARIABLE`.

Control

Term	Meaning
Control Basic	The panel's programming language. Programs are written in numbered lines, in the style of BASIC.
Program	A Control Basic program held by a panel. A panel runs its programs once per scan.
PRG file	A file holding a panel's database record — points, names, ranges, settings — so it can be carried between machines without the panel.
PID loop	A control loop that corrects an output from the error between a setpoint and a measured value, using proportional, integral and derivative terms.
Setpoint	The value a loop is trying to reach.
Process variable	The measured value a loop is trying to hold at the setpoint.
Schedule	A weekly program: which hours of which days a panel does something. Repeats every seven days.
Annual routine	The year's exceptions — holidays and one-off closures — applied on top of the weekly schedules.
Auto / manual	Whether a point is driven by the panel's own logic (*auto*) or held at a value somebody typed (*manual*). A manual point ignores its program.

Records

Term	Meaning
Trend log	A record of a point's value over time, stored so the history can be read back and graphed.
Alarm	A condition the panel reports when a point crosses a limit, with the time it happened and whether it was acknowledged.
Graphic screen	A drawing of the plant with live points placed on it, so a system can be read at a glance.
Building database	The stored copy of every panel's points and settings. It exists whether or not the panels are online, which is what allows a site to be built before the hardware is.
Offline mode	Working with the building database when no panel is reachable.
Write / read back	Sending a value or a table to a panel, then reading it to confirm what the panel actually holds.

Connections

Term	Meaning
COM port	A serial port on the PC or the panel. T3000 numbers them `COM0`, `COM1`, `COM2`.
MSTP	BACnet over a serial segment — the BACnet equivalent of Modbus RTU.
BBMD	A BACnet broadcast management device, which lets broadcast traffic cross between IP subnets.
Port forwarding	A router rule that lets a connection from outside reach a device inside. Needed for direct access to a panel.
VPN	A tunnel that makes a remote network reachable as though it were local.
WireGuard	The VPN protocol T3000 is being built to configure itself, per remote site rather than per panel.
Firmware	The software inside a panel. Updating it is a maintenance task, and the update is checked by version.